SE 423 Mechatronics
LabVIEW Assignment #4

This is an optional assignment if you would like to learn about how LABVIEW can be used like MATLAB/Simulink to simulate system equations.

Exercise 1

For this exercise, I would like you to reproduce the two VIs shown in the pictures below. Both VIs perform the same task using different methods to implement an "if-else" condition, and one uses a SubVI. Again, for this exercise, start by creating a LabVIEW Project. Then, inside this project, add a single VI. We are using a project this time, so the SubVI you create will be saved in it. I will give some pointers and instructions below, but you will need to do some of your own hunting to find the necessary blocks and other parts of the program, and use LabVIEW help to figure out how to use/wire certain blocks. Many of the blocks I used below come from the "Control Design & Simulation → Simulation" section of LabVIEW.

Reproduce the below VI.

Instructions/tips:

1. The entire program is inside a Simulation Loop. The default simulation settings should work fine for this exercise.
2. You will notice that I am using a Case Structure in this VI. The case structure is implementing the following if statement:

```
if (velocity > 0) {
    FricComp = Vpos*velocity + Cpos;  // viscous friction*velocity + static friction
} else {
    FricComp = Vneg*velocity + Cneg;
}
```

3. The signal generator is set to Square wave, Amplitude of 1, and frequency of .1 hertz
4. Gain Blocks are set to “terminal” mode so that the gain can be changed with a control.
5. We are implementing a PID controller. Gain values are displayed in the Control Items section of the Front Panel window.
6. The Plant transfer function is $\frac{1600}{s^3+14s^2+448s+3200}$.
7. $\frac{100s}{s+100}$ is an approximation of a derivative.
8. The Graph is a SimTime Waveform block.
9. I am using a Build Array block before the SimTime Waveform to plot two signals on a single graph.
10. More steps continue below.

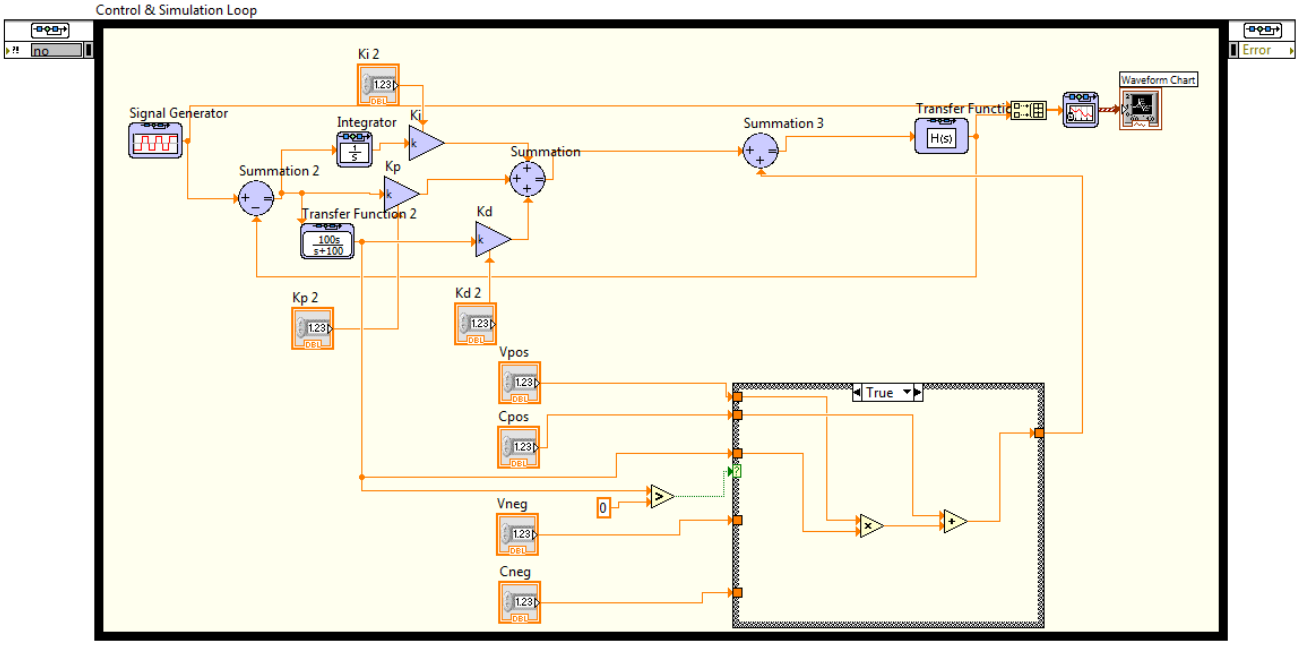


Figure 1: Reference VI front panel

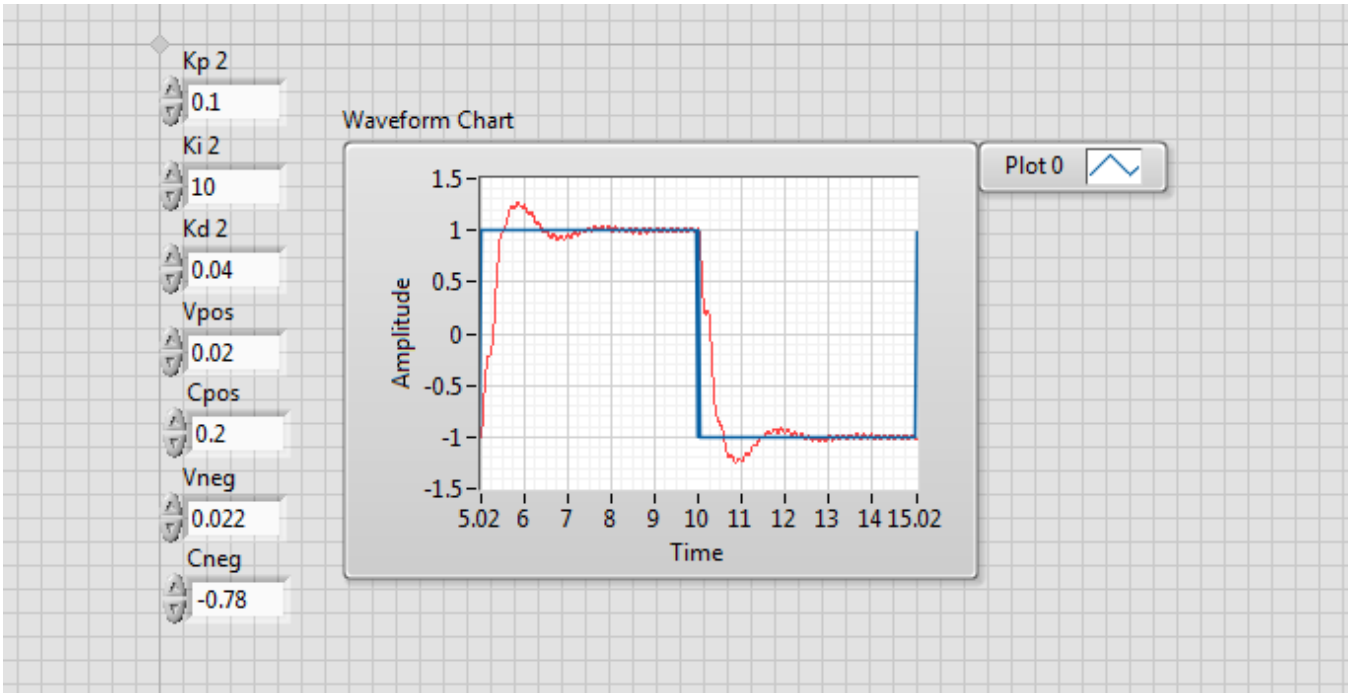


Figure 2: Reference VI block diagram

11. Now, as a final task for this VI, change the Friction Compensation part of the VI into a SubVI. See the following tutorial to help you create this SubVI from the blocks already in your simulation. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zr2qqv1F4kk

12. Make a simple Icon for your VI and connect the inputs and outputs to the pattern shown in the picture below. There is also another picture below of the simulation with the SubVI.

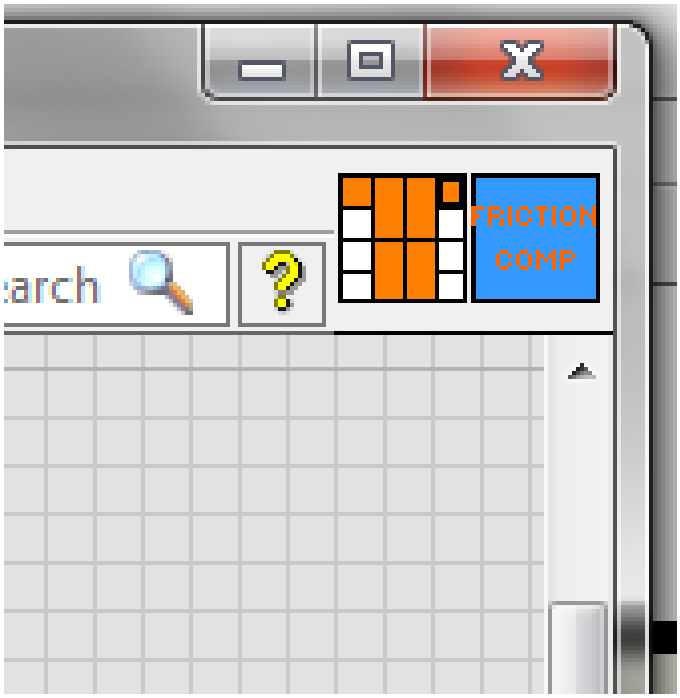


Figure 3: Picture of Icon and Pattern to use

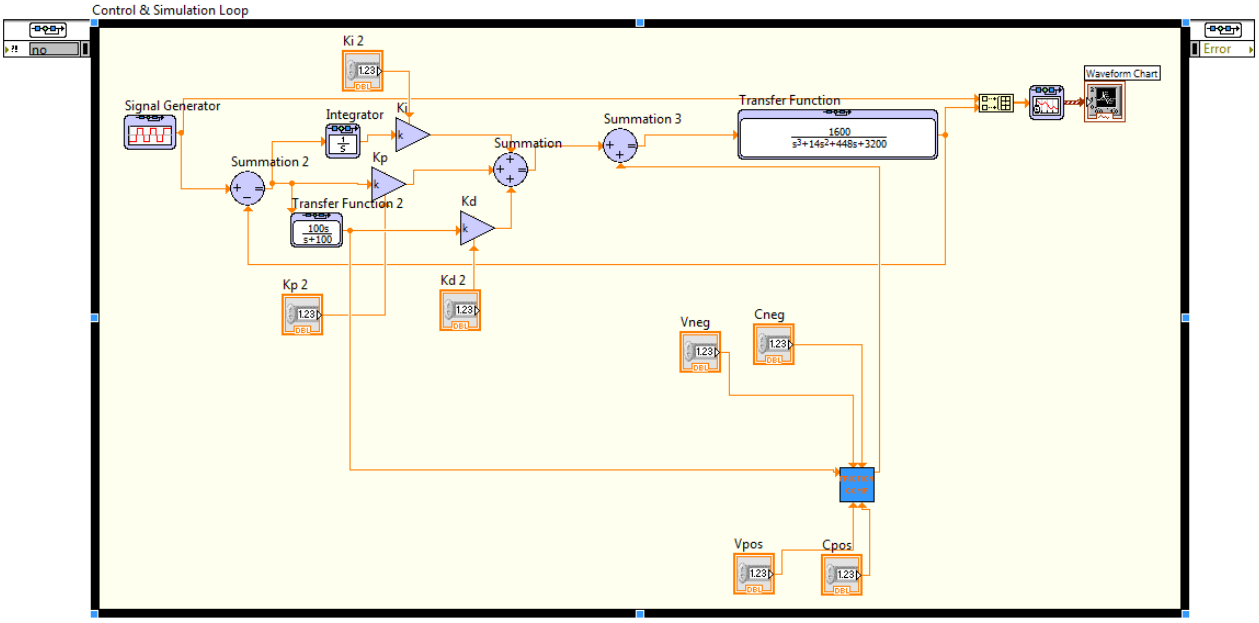


Figure 4: Picture with SubVI

13. Now, either create a new VI, or you can copy the Simulation Loop and all of its contents and run two simulation loops in one VI.

14. Here, in this new VI or simulation loop, everything is the same except I would

like you to replace the SubVI with a Formula Node. A Formula Node allows you to add small amounts of C code to your LabVIEW program.

15. To add a variable to a formula node, right-click on an edge of the formula node and select “Add Input.” To add an output for the formula, right-click on an edge and select “Add Output.”

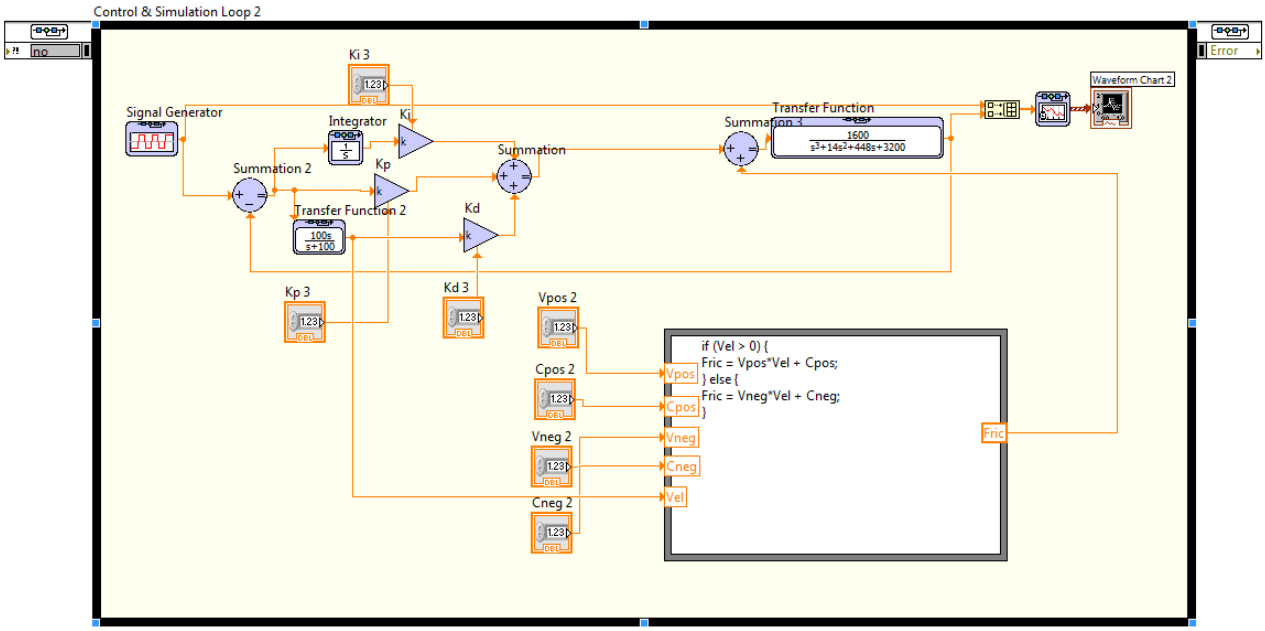


Figure 5: Friction compensation with a Formula Node